

# **General Knowledge**

## **Art & Culture**

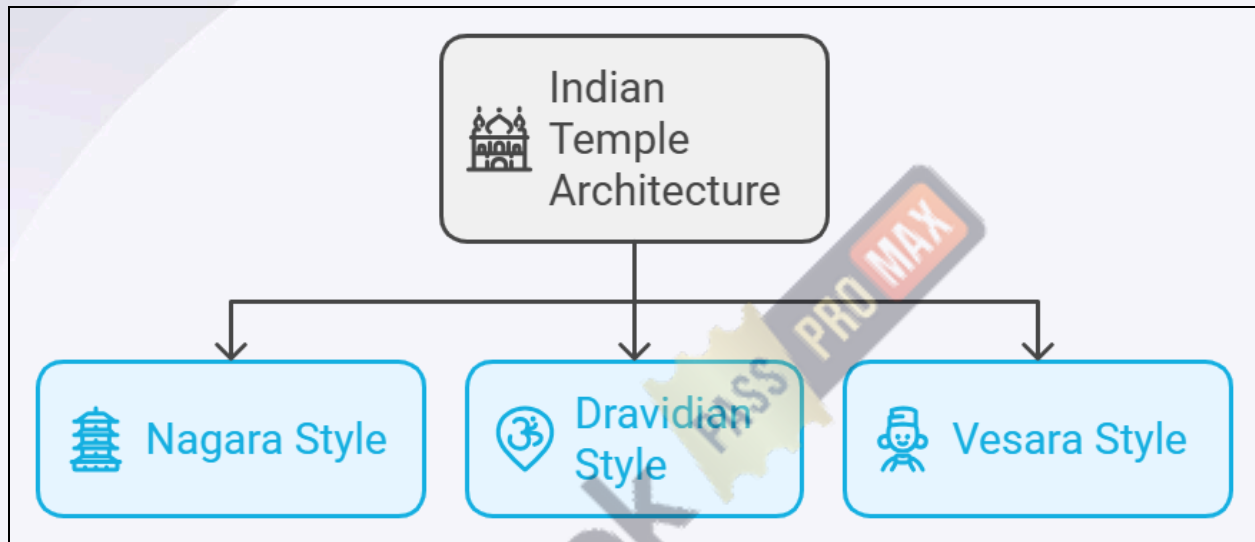
### **STUDY NOTES**

#### **Temple Architecture**



## Temple Architecture

Temple architecture in India is a significant aspect of the country's cultural heritage. It reflects the religious beliefs, socio-economic conditions, and artistic achievements of various periods. Indian temple architecture can be broadly categorized into three major styles: **Nagara**, **Dravidian**, and **Vesara**.



### Terms Related to Temple

| Term                             | Description                                                                                             |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Mandappa<br/>(Entrance)</b>   | The entrance to the temple provides space for worshippers.                                              |
| <b>Sanctum<br/>(Garbhagriha)</b> | They are also known as the "womb-house", a small cubicle housing the main deity with a single entrance. |
| <b>Shikhar</b>                   | The mountain-like spire on top of the temple.                                                           |
| <b>Vahan</b>                     | The mount or vehicle of the temple's deity symbolises the deity's power.                                |

|                               |                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Dhvaj</b>                  | The standard pillar, often placed before the sanctum, represents the temple and deity.                              |
| <b>Mandap</b>                 | A pillared hall or pavilion, often located before the sanctum, is used for rituals and prayers.                     |
| <b>Pradakshina Path</b>       | The path around the sanctum, where worshippers walk in a circular motion during the worship.                        |
| <b>Antechamber</b>            | A small, intermediate room before the sanctum, often used by priests or for special rituals.                        |
| <b>Shikhara (North India)</b> | The curving, mountain-like spire on top of the temple, is typical in Northern Indian temples.                       |
| <b>Vimana (South India)</b>   | The pyramidal tower over the sanctum is typical in Southern Indian temples.                                         |
| <b>Garuda Stambha</b>         | A pillar is often placed at the entrance or within the temple complex, depicting Garuda (the mount of Lord Vishnu). |
| <b>Kumbha</b>                 | A large, pot-like structure atop the temple or sanctum, often symbolising fertility and protection.                 |
| <b>Yajna Kund</b>             | A sacred fire pit is used for conducting religious rituals and sacrifices, usually outside or near the temple.      |

## Styles of Temple Architecture

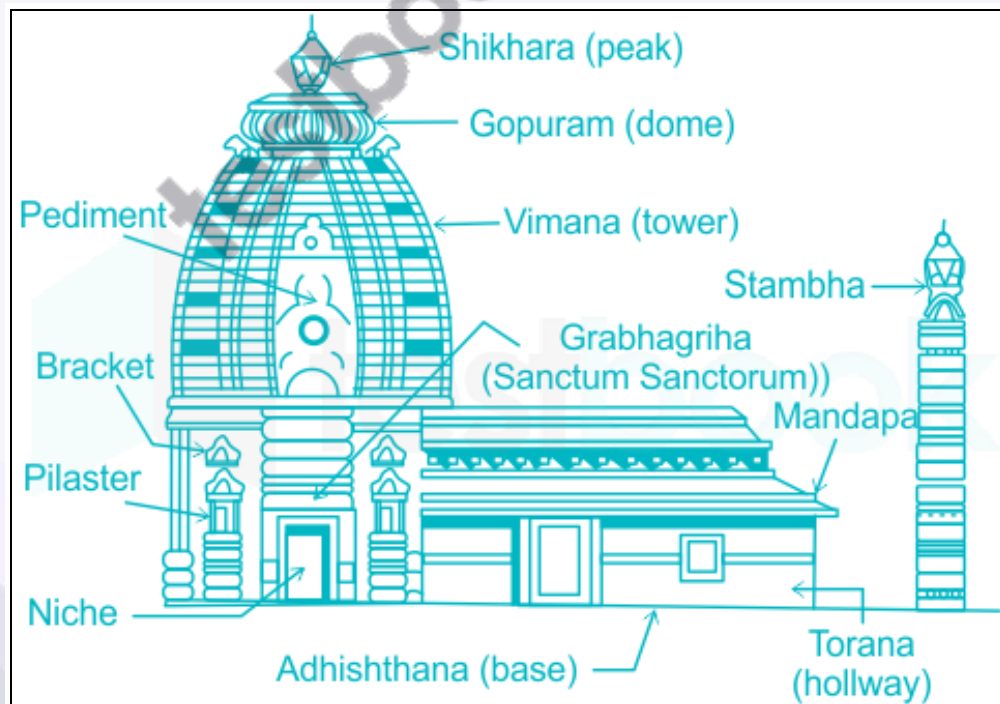
| Feature       | Nagara Architecture                 | Dravidian Architecture              | Vesara Architecture                                                |
|---------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Region</b> | Predominantly found in North India. | Predominantly found in South India. | A blend of North and South Indian styles, mainly in Central India. |

|                                    |                                                                               |                                                                                          |                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Shikhara<br/>(Temple Tower)</b> | Curvilinear, steep, and often pointed spire.                                  | Pyramidal or tiered tower with horizontal division of roofs.                             | Combination of the curvilinear Shikhara of Nagara and the pyramidal tower of Dravidian. |
| <b>Sanctum<br/>(Garbhagriha)</b>   | Smaller sanctum, often square or rectangular.                                 | Larger sanctum, usually square, with a tower above it.                                   | Medium-sized sanctum with a blend of Nagara and Dravidian styles.                       |
| <b>Mandapa (Hall)</b>              | Generally small, simple pillared hall in front of the sanctum.                | Large pillared halls or halls (often several), used for rituals.                         | Smaller halls, often less elaborate than Dravidian but more intricate than Nagara.      |
| <b>Pillars</b>                     | Slim, decorative, and sometimes with intricate carvings.                      | Massive, sometimes sculptured pillars with more grandeur.                                | Pillars are intermediate in size and design between Nagara and Dravidian.               |
| <b>Plan Layout</b>                 | Square or rectangular layout.                                                 | Often follows a rectangular or square plan with a strict axial alignment.                | Hybrid, combining elements of both Nagara and Dravidian plans.                          |
| <b>Examples</b>                    | Temples like the Kandariya Mahadev in Khajuraho, or the Sun Temple at Konark. | Temples like the Brihadeeswarar Temple in Thanjavur, or the Meenakshi Temple in Madurai. | Temples like the Chaturbhuja Temple at Orchha, or the temples in Karnataka.             |

|                           |                                      |                                                               |                                                                                        |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Regional Influence</b> | Influenced by Indo-Aryan traditions. | Heavily influenced by Dravidian culture and Tamil traditions. | Combination of Indo-Aryan and Dravidian elements, typically in regions like Karnataka. |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|



## Nagara Temple Architecture



## Kalinga Temple Architecture in India

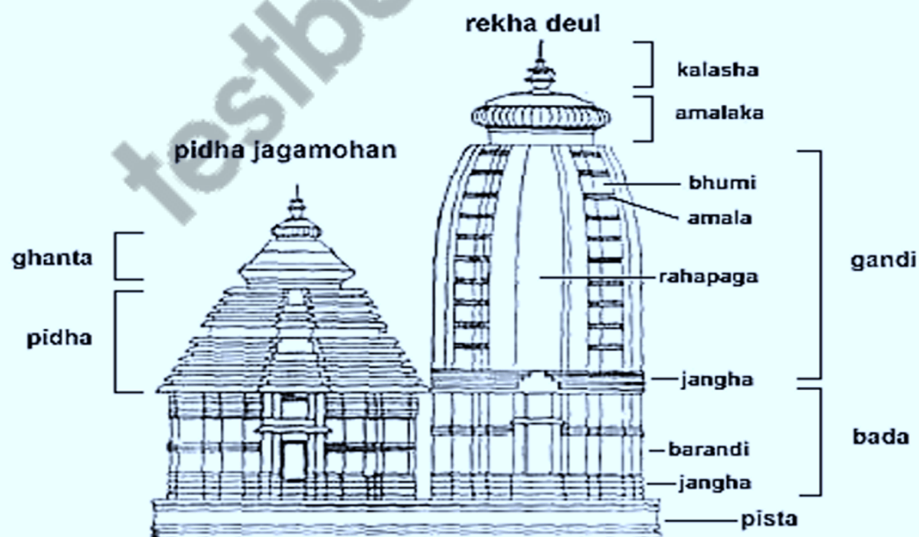
**Introduction:** Kalinga temple architecture refers to the distinctive style of temple construction that developed in the Kalinga region (modern-day Odisha) during the ancient and medieval periods. It is known for its unique design elements and its influence on the religious and cultural landscape of Eastern India.

### Key Characteristics of Kalinga Temple Architecture:

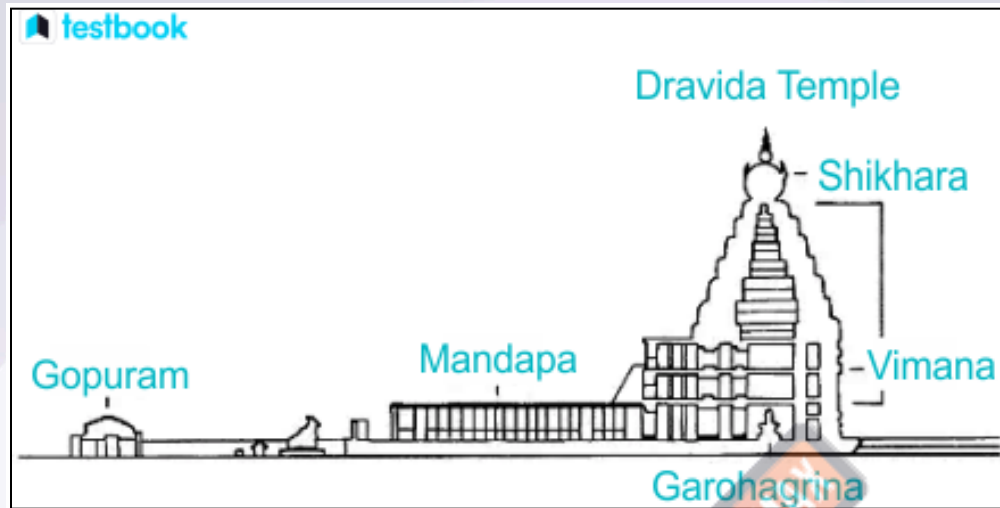
- **Shikhara (Temple Tower):**
  - **Curved or receding** tower (Vimana), typically **beehive-shaped**.
  - Tapers as it rises, different from Dravidian and Nagara styles.
- **Sanctum (Garbhagriha):**
  - **Square or rectangular** sanctum housing the main deity.
  - **The beehive-shaped dome** on top.
- **Jagamohana (Hall):**
  - Large, pillared **rectangular hall** in front of the sanctum.
  - Space for devotees to congregate and pray.
- **Ratha (Chariot-like Structure):**
  - Chariot-shaped feature, symbolic of the divine journey.
  - Often adorned with **wheel motifs** and carvings.
- **Deula (Main Temple Structure):**
  - The central structure includes the sanctum, Jagamohana, and sometimes a **Natamandira**.
  - Features **intricate carvings** of gods, goddesses, and mythological scenes.
- **Exterior Walls:**
  - Richly **sculpted walls** with reliefs of Hindu deities and celestial beings.
  - Detailed **narrative carvings** depicting religious stories.
- **Material:**
  - Constructed using **sandstone** and **laterite stones**.
  - Precision in stonework and carvings.

### Notable Kalinga Temples:

- **Jagannath Temple, Puri (Odisha):**
  - The most famous and iconic example of Kalinga architecture is dedicated to Lord Jagannath.
  - **Period:** 12th century CE, built by King Anantavarman Chodaganga Deva.
- **Konark Sun Temple (Odisha):**
  - This temple is known for its **chariot-shaped design**, with intricately carved stone wheels that symbolize the passage of time. It was built in the 13th century CE by King Narasimhadeva I of the Eastern Ganga dynasty.
- **Lingaraj Temple (Bhubaneswar, Odisha):**
  - A quintessential example of Kalinga temple architecture, this temple is dedicated to Lord Shiva. It was built in the 11th century CE by the Somavamsi rulers.
- **Rajarani Temple (Bhubaneswar, Odisha):**
  - Known for its smooth, graceful design and absence of any deities in the sanctum. It features **carved walls** and fine ornamental sculptures.
  - **Period:** 11th century CE, built by the Somavamsi dynasty.



## Dravida Temple Architecture



Several prominent styles of Dravidian architecture emerged over the centuries:

| Architectural Style                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Picture |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <p><b>Chola Style:</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• It is predominantly from 9th to 13th century.</li><li>• It has Large towers (Vimana), pillared halls (Mandapas), and intricate sculptures. Example: Brihadeshwara Temple in Thanjavur.</li></ul> |         |

**Pallava Style:**

- It is predominantly from 7th to 9th century.
- It has Rock-cut architecture and monolithic temples.
- Example: Shore Temple and the rock-cut temples of Mahabalipuram.


**Pandya Style:**

- It is predominantly from 13th to 16th century.
- It has Temples with towering gateway towers (Gopurams) and extensive use of stone carvings.
- Example: Aranganathar temple in Srirangam


**Vijayanagara Style:**

- It is predominantly 14th to 17th century.
- It has Huge gopurams, expansive temple complexes, and ornate sculptures. Example: Virupaksha Temple in Hampi.
- Virupaksha Temple, Hampi is an example.



**Hoysala style:**

- This style of temple architecture is found mainly in the Karnataka region of India and is characterized by its delicate carvings and intricate ornamentation.
- It is known for its exquisite craftsmanship and intricate detailing, Hoysala architecture is a significant part of India's architectural heritage
- The Hoysala temples are often decorated with sculptures of animals, birds, and flowers, as well as with images of gods and goddesses.
- Example: Chennakeshava Temple, Belur, Karnataka.

**Vesara style: (North India and South India Mixture)**

- This style of temple architecture is a fusion of the Nagara and Dravida styles and is found mainly in the Deccan region of India.
- It is characterized by a shikhara that is more angular than the Nagara shikhara and a vimana that is more ornate than the Dravida vimana.
- Example: Hoysaleswara Temple in Halebidu, Karnataka.



### Chalukyan style:

- This style of temple architecture is found mainly in the Deccan region of India and is characterized by its elaborately carved pillars and doorways.
- It flourished from the 6th to the 12th centuries.
- The pillars are often decorated with sculptures of animals and mythical creatures, while the doorways are often decorated with intricate carvings of gods and goddesses.
- Example: Badami cave temples in Karnataka.



## State-Wise Famous Temples in India

| Temple                         | Location       | Architectural Style | Dynasty/Ruler            | Year/Time Period                 |
|--------------------------------|----------------|---------------------|--------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Tirupati Balaji Temple</b>  | Andhra Pradesh | Dravidian           | Tiruvenkatapathy Rulers  | 9th Century (original structure) |
| <b>Kashi Vishwanath Temple</b> | Uttar Pradesh  | Nagara              | Maratha Rulers (rebuilt) | 1780 CE (rebuilt)                |
| <b>Meenakshi Temple</b>        | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian           | Nayak Dynasty            | 17th Century                     |
| <b>Ramanathaswamy Temple</b>   | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian           | Pandya Dynasty           | 12th Century                     |

|                             |                 |            |                                        |                          |
|-----------------------------|-----------------|------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Siddhivinayak Temple</b> | Maharashtra     | Nagara     | Laxman Vithu & Bhivaji Patil (rebuilt) | 1801 CE (rebuilt)        |
| <b>Dwarkadhish Temple</b>   | Gujarat         | Chaulukya  | Chaulukya Dynasty                      | 12th Century             |
| <b>Golden Temple</b>        | Punjab          | Sikh       | Maharaja Ranjit Singh                  | 1581 CE (reconstruction) |
| <b>Badrinath Temple</b>     | Uttarakhand     | Nagara     | King of Garhwal                        | 9th Century              |
| <b>Kedarnath Temple</b>     | Uttarakhand     | Dravidian  | Pandavas (mythological attribution)    | 8th Century              |
| <b>Sai Baba Temple</b>      | Maharashtra     | Modern     | Built by Devotees of Sai Baba          | Early 20th Century       |
| <b>Virupaksha Temple</b>    | Karnataka       | Dravidian  | Vikramaditya (Chalukya Dynasty)        | 7th Century              |
| <b>Chidambaram Temple</b>   | Tamil Nadu      | Dravidian  | Chola Dynasty                          | 10th Century             |
| <b>Somnath Temple</b>       | Gujarat         | Chalukya   | Mahmud of Ghazni (destroyed)           | 1026 CE (destroyed)      |
| <b>Jagdish Temple</b>       | Rajasthan       | Indo-Aryan | Maharana Jagat Singh I                 | 1651 CE                  |
| <b>Vaishno Devi Temple</b>  | Jammu & Kashmir | Dravidian  | Maharaja Gulab Singh                   | 19th Century             |

|                                    |                |                |                          |                                    |
|------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple</b> | Kerala         | Dravidian      | Maharaja Marthanda Varma | 1733 CE                            |
| <b>Lingaraj Temple</b>             | Odisha         | Kalinga/Nagara | Somavamsi Dynasty        | 11th Century                       |
| <b>Sun Temple</b>                  | Odisha         | Kalinga/Nagara | King Narasimhadeva I     | 13th Century                       |
| <b>Kailasa Temple</b>              | Maharashtra    | Rock-Cut       | Rashtrakuta Dynasty      | 8th Century                        |
| <b>Badami Cave Temples</b>         | Karnataka      | Rock-Cut       | Chalukya Dynasty         | 6th Century                        |
| <b>Shore Temple</b>                | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Pallava Dynasty          | 8th Century                        |
| <b>Meghalaya Temple</b>            | Meghalaya      | Indigenous     | Khasi Kingdom            | 17th Century                       |
| <b>Rajagopalaswamy Temple</b>      | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Chola Dynasty            | 12th Century                       |
| <b>Hampi Temple</b>                | Karnataka      | Dravidian      | Vijayanagara Empire      | 14th Century                       |
| <b>Ranganathaswamy Temple</b>      | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Vijayanagara Dynasty     | 16th Century                       |
| <b>Mahakaleshwar Temple</b>        | Madhya Pradesh | Nagara         | Gupta Dynasty (rebuilt)  | 4th Century (rebuilt 18th Century) |
| <b>Tungabhadra Temple</b>          | Karnataka      | Dravidian      | Vijayanagara Empire      | 16th Century                       |

|                                     |                |                |                                 |                   |
|-------------------------------------|----------------|----------------|---------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Kanchipuram Kailasanathar</b>    | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Pallava Dynasty                 | 8th Century       |
| <b>Gangaikondacholapuram Temple</b> | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Chola Dynasty                   | 11th Century      |
| <b>Vishwanath Temple</b>            | Uttar Pradesh  | Nagara         | Maratha Dynasty (rebuilt)       | 1780 CE (rebuilt) |
| <b>Mallikarjuna Temple</b>          | Andhra Pradesh | Dravidian      | Chalukya Dynasty                | 7th Century       |
| <b>Rajarajeshwar Temple</b>         | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Chola Dynasty                   | 11th Century      |
| <b>Jambukeswarar Temple</b>         | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Chola Dynasty                   | 9th Century       |
| <b>Annamalaiyar Temple</b>          | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Pandya Dynasty (reconstruction) | 9th Century       |
| <b>Brahmapureeswarar Temple</b>     | Tamil Nadu     | Dravidian      | Chola Dynasty                   | 9th Century       |
| <b>Bharateshwar Temple</b>          | Gujarat        | Dravidian      | Maurya Dynasty                  | 6th Century       |
| <b>Trimbakeshwar Temple</b>         | Maharashtra    | Nagara         | Maratha Dynasty                 | 18th Century      |
| <b>Kartikeya Temple</b>             | Rajasthan      | Indo-Aryan     | Rajput Kings                    | 6th Century       |
| <b>Srisailam Temple</b>             | Andhra Pradesh | Dravidian      | Satavahana Dynasty              | 2nd Century BC    |
| <b>Gokarna Temple</b>               | Karnataka      | Dravidian      | Chalukya Dynasty                | 6th Century       |
| <b>Puri Jagannath Temple</b>        | Odisha         | Kalinga/Nagara | Ganga Dynasty                   | 12th Century      |

|                           |                  |           |                                           |                |
|---------------------------|------------------|-----------|-------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Kedareswar Temple</b>  | Uttarakhand      | Dravidian | Pandavas<br>(mythological attribution)    | 8th Century    |
| <b>Omkareshwar Temple</b> | Madhya Pradesh   | Nagara    | Parmara Dynasty                           | 12th Century   |
| <b>Bageshwar Temple</b>   | Uttarakhand      | Nagara    | Kumaon Rulers                             | 16th Century   |
| <b>Guruvayur Temple</b>   | Kerala           | Dravidian | Lord Vishnu<br>(mythological attribution) | Ancient Temple |
| <b>Kartikeya Temple</b>   | Tamil Nadu       | Dravidian | Chola Dynasty                             | 9th Century    |
| <b>Pandharpur Temple</b>  | Maharashtra      | Nagara    | Yadava Dynasty                            | 12th Century   |
| <b>Dattatreya Temple</b>  | Maharashtra      | Dravidian | Satavahana Dynasty                        | 3rd Century BC |
| <b>Alopi Devi Temple</b>  | Uttar Pradesh    | Nagara    | Unknown                                   | 19th Century   |
| <b>Khajuraho Temple</b>   | Madhya Pradesh   | Nagara    | Chandela Dynasty                          | 10th Century   |
| <b>Jwala Ji Temple</b>    | Himachal Pradesh | Himalayan | Rajput Kings                              | 19th Century   |
| <b>Chaturbhuji Temple</b> | Madhya Pradesh   | Nagara    | Bundela Dynasty                           | 16th Century   |
| <b>Kalighat Temple</b>    | West Bengal      | Dravidian | Early Hindu Kings                         | 1800s          |

## Some Important Monasteries and Features

| Monastery         | Location                                  | Features                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tabo Monastery    | Lahaul and Spiti Valley, Himachal Pradesh | One of the most popular monasteries in Lahaul and Spiti Valley                                                                    |
| Namgyal Monastery | Dharamshala, Himachal Pradesh             | All rituals from the major schools for Tibetan Buddhism are practised here                                                        |
| Key Monastery     | Himachal Pradesh                          | The largest and oldest monastery in Lahaul and Spiti; repository of rare Buddhist relics and literature; home to around 300 lamas |
| Shashur Monastery | Shashur Gompa, Lahaul, Himachal Pradesh   | Founded by the Lama Dewa Tyatsho from Ladakh                                                                                      |